

# The mahjong-tiles Package

## Typesetting Riichi Mahjong Hands and Discard Rivers

Lilia Chen May Wither

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### Abstract

`mahjong-tiles` typesets Japanese/Riichi Mahjong tiles from compact MPSZ notation. It provides a document command, `\mahjong`, for hands and melds, and `\mahjongriver` for discard rivers, and `\stick` for score-stick images. It supports red fives, face-down and blank tiles, rotated and stacked tiles, concealed-kong shorthand, local and global size options, and recolouring of tile backs.

## 1 Loading the package

A minimal document looks like this.

If you are working from the CTAN source archive, generate the runtime package file first:

```
latex mahjong-tiles.ins
```

The distributed user manual lives in `doc/mahjong-tiles-doc.pdf`;

Its source is `doc/mahjong-tiles-doc.tex`;

The package implementation source is `mahjong-tiles.dtx`;

And `mahjong-tiles.ins` extracts `mahjong-tiles.sty`.

```
\documentclass{article}
\usepackage{mahjong-tiles}
\begin{document}
\mahjong{111m456s111p11122z}
\end{document}
```

The package expects the PDF artwork in the `tiles/` directory. With the default setting, `mahjong-tiles.sty` and `tiles/` should be installed in the same TeX-searchable package directory.

## 2 Package options

Options can be supplied when loading the package or changed later with `\mahjongtilessetup`.

```
\usepackage[
  height=1.5\baselineskip,
  scale=0.75,
  color=blue!70!black,
  aka=1
]{mahjong-tiles}
```

```
\mahjongtilessetup{height=1.5\baselineskip,scale=0.75,color=teal!65!black,aka=1}
```

| Option        | Default       | Description                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| height        | \baselineskip | Height of one upright tile.                                                                                                                                                        |
| scale         | 0.75          | Scale factor for the tile symbol relative to the tile face.                                                                                                                        |
| tile-dir      | tiles         | Directory containing the tile PDF files.                                                                                                                                           |
| color         | none          | Recolour the tile back. Use any xcolor colour expression, or <b>none</b> for the embedded artwork.                                                                                 |
| aka           | 1             | Red-five mode: 0 disables red fives and maps 0m, 0p, and 0s to regular fives; 1 renders them normally; 2 also makes 55555p show an extra red five pin in concealed-kong shorthand. |
| river-cols    | 6             | Number of tiles per discard-river row.                                                                                                                                             |
| river-row-gap | 0pt           | Vertical gap between discard-river rows.                                                                                                                                           |
| stick-dir     | assets/stick  | Directory containing the score-stick PDF files.                                                                                                                                    |
| stick-height  | \baselineskip | Height of one upright score-stick image.                                                                                                                                           |
| stick-scale   | .5            | Scale factor applied to score-stick images.                                                                                                                                        |
| stick-sep     | .5em          | Horizontal space between different score-stick groups.                                                                                                                             |

### 3 The \mahjong command

```
\mahjong{<tiles>}
\mahjong[<height>][<scale>][<back-colour>][<local-keys>]{<tiles>}
\mahjong[<local-keys>]{<tiles>}
```

The first optional argument also accepts a key-value list. This allows compact local overrides such as:

```
\mahjong[height=1.5\baselineskip,scale=0.75,color=teal!65!black,aka=0]{x 0m0p0s}
```

### 4 MPSZ notation

A tile is written as one or more digits followed by a suit letter. The suits are **m** for manzu, **p** for pinzu, **s** for souzu, and **z** for honors.

| Input              | Output |
|--------------------|--------|
| 111m456s111p11122z |        |
| 1112345678999p     |        |
| 19m19s19p1234567z  |        |

#### 4.1 Special tokens

| Token      | Meaning                                                    |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0m, 0p, 0s | Red fives:                                                 |
| x          | Face-down tile:                                            |
| ?          | Unknown blank tile:                                        |
| -          | Full visual gap between groups.                            |
| N-         | Proportional gap of N/7 of one tile width, for example 2-. |

## 4.2 Rotated and stacked tiles

The marker `*` or an apostrophe rotates the preceding tile sideways. For ordinary tiles, the marker `+` or a double quote stacks two sideways copies of the preceding tile, which is useful for kan notation.

There is one red-five edge syntax for upgraded-kan notation. With `aka` enabled, `0m`", `0p`", and `0s`" produce a mixed sideways stack with the red five at the bottom and the regular five at the top. Repeating the stack marker twice, as in `0p`" or `0p++`, flips the red five to the top. Three markers, `0p`" or `0p+++`, force two red fives and deliberately ignore `aka`. The same rule applies to `m`, `p`, and `s`.

| Input                   | Output |
|-------------------------|--------|
| 111m111s111p22z2-3*333z |        |
| 123m-xx?4p'5p"0s        |        |
| 0p" 0p" 0p"             |        |
| 0p+ 0p++ 0p+++          |        |
| aka=0: 0p" 0p" 0p"      |        |

## 4.3 Red fives and the aka option

Red fives are controlled by the integer `aka` option. The default `aka=1` renders `0m`, `0p`, and `0s` as red fives. Set `aka=0` to suppress red fives and render those inputs as regular fives. Set `aka=2` to keep normal red fives and add one more red five pin in the `55555p` concealed-kong shorthand.

| Input                          | Output |
|--------------------------------|--------|
| 0m0p0s55555m                   |        |
| \mahjong [aka=0]{0m0p0s55555p} |        |
| \mahjong [aka=2]{55555p}       |        |

## 4.4 Concealed kongs

Five identical consecutive digits followed by a suit are rendered as a concealed kan: a face-down tile, two visible tiles, and a face-down tile. For suited fives, the visible pair is controlled by `aka`: `aka=0` gives two regular fives, `aka=1` gives a red five plus a regular five, and `aka=2` gives `55555p` two red five-pin tiles.

| Input                    | Output |
|--------------------------|--------|
| 55555p                   |        |
| 33333z                   |        |
| \mahjong [aka=0]{55555s} |        |
| \mahjong [aka=2]{55555p} |        |

For compatibility with older documents, the deprecated option `no-aka` is still accepted. It is equivalent to `aka=0` and emits a package warning. New documents should use `aka=0` directly.

```
\mahjong[aka=0]{0m0p0s}
% Deprecated:
\mahjong[no-aka=1]{0m0p0s}
```

## 5 Tile-back recolouring

The tile-back colour can be set globally or locally. The colour value is passed to `xcolor`. The special value `none` restores the embedded back tile.

```
\mahjongtilessetup{color=purple!70!black}  
\mahjong{x x x}  
  
\mahjong[color=teal!65!black]{x x x}  
\mahjong[color=none]{x x x}
```



## 6 Discard rivers

The `\mahjongriver` command uses the same notation as `\mahjong`, but it breaks tiles into rows. The row length is controlled by `river-cols`.

```
\mahjongriver{1m9m2z5z3s6s1s1m8p4z87m}  
\mahjongriver[river-cols=6]{1m9m2z5z3s6s1s*1m8p4z87m}
```

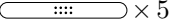
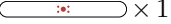
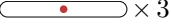
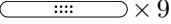


## 7 Score sticks

The `\stick` command typesets Japanese Mahjong score sticks. The argument may be a three-digit shorthand amount, or a manual specification of stick counts.

A three-digit input is interpreted as hundreds of points. For example, 305 represents 30500 points. The package decomposes the value into an optimal combination of 10k, 5k, 1k, and 100 sticks.

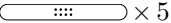
The default artwork directory is `assets/stick/`. It should contain `10k.pdf`, `5k.pdf`, `1k.pdf`, and `100.pdf`.

| Input                     | Output                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>\stick {305}</code> |  $\times 3$  $\times 5$                                                                                                  |
| <code>\stick {089}</code> |  $\times 1$  $\times 3$  $\times 9$ |
| <code>\stick {250}</code> |  $\times 2$  $\times 1$                                                                                                  |

For 305, the automatic decomposition is:

```
10k \ctimes 3  
100 \ctimes 5
```

Manual input is also supported. The key-value form names each stick type explicitly.

| Input                             | Output                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>\stick {10k=3,100=5}</code> |  $\times 3$  $\times 5$ |

---

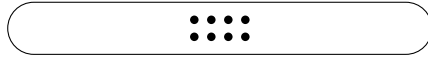
|                                       |                                                                                       |                                                                                        |                                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>\stick {5k=1,1k=2,100=4}</code> |  × 1 |  × 2 |  × 4 |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

---

The compact comma-list form gives the counts in the order 10k, 5k, 1k, 100.

| Input                                 | Output                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>\stick {3,0,0,5}</code>         |  × 3  × 5                                                                                         |
| <code>\stick [manual]{0,1,2,4}</code> |  × 1  × 2  × 4 |

The command accepts local options. These options affect only the current `\stick` call.

| Input                                         | Output                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>\stick [height=2em,scale=1]{305}</code> | <div> × 3</div> <div> × 5</div> |

The score-stick defaults can also be changed globally:

```
\mahjongtilessetup{
  stick-dir=assets/stick,
  stick-height=1.2em,
  stick-scale=1,
  stick-sep=.6em
}
```

If the artwork is installed somewhere else, set `stick-dir` accordingly:

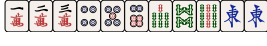
```
\mahjongtilessetup{stick-dir=/assets/stick}
```

## 8 Overlay notes

The `\mahjong` command supports text annotations. Use `[]` in `\mahjong` to attach a note above the previous tile.

Annotations may contain ordinary TeX material. Mahjong tiles inside an annotation are rendered only when they are explicitly wrapped in `\mj`. For example, `[waiting \mj{3m}]` prints the text "waiting" followed by a small mahjong tile in the annotation. The `\mj` command is parsed only one level deep inside annotations.

The `\mj` command may also be used directly inside `\mahjong`. In that case, its argument must contain exactly one tile. The tile is typeset as a normal-size rotated tile above the hand, which is useful for showing a drawn tile.

| Input                                                                            | Output                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>111m111s111p2z2-3*333z7-2z[waiting]</code>                                 |  |
| <code>123m456p789s\mj {2z}11z</code>                                             |  |
| <code>111m113s111p2z2-3*333z7-2z[discard \mj {3s},\ waiting \mj {1s2-2z}]</code> |  |

33333z[concealed kong]

concealed kong



---

When a note is added to the fifth tile of a concealed kong shorthand, a warning `Overlay text '<overlay text>'` is attached to the final back tile of a concealed kong. will be triggered. Since a concealed kong is rendered as four tiles, the note is moved to the fourth rendered tile, namely the final back tile.

## 9 Expl3 interface

For package authors who prefer an expl3-style interface, mahjong-tiles also exposes:

```
\ExplSyntaxOn
\mahjongtiles_typeset_hand:n {111m456s111p11122z}
\mahjongtilesriver:n         {111m456s111p11122z}
\ExplSyntaxOff
```

## 10 Attribution and licence

The LaTeX package code is distributed under the MIT Licence. Portions are based on Daniel Schmitz's mahjong package, copyright 2021 Daniel Schmitz, also under the MIT Licence.

The tile artwork in `tiles/` is derived from FluffyStuff's `riichi-mahjong-tiles` project. The upstream licence file places that work in the public domain/CC0. Attribution is retained here and in the README.